

DETECTIVE'S GAMBIT

Welcome to Detective's Gambit, where it's all about sharpening critical thinking and problem solving skills. It's a race against riddles, codes, and cunning deceptions that will test how far your instincts can take you when evidence runs thin. This category isn't just fun, it challenges the mind to work like a true detective. Step in with focus, play with courage, and prepare to uncover the truth that refuses to stay buried!

ROUND 1: BLACK, GREY OR RED HERRING

ROUND DURATION: 3 hrs

DELEGATE CAP: 2

ELIMINATION: Active

Delegates will have to put on their CSI hats and distinguish between the black and grey, grasping onto the threads of relevance that tie each entity to the case at hand.

Presented with a wide variety of objects, it is their sharp eye for detail that will get delegates through this round. Delegates will be given time to familiarise themselves with the case files before proceeding to examine the objects presented at each station. They will then assess each object in the context of the case and determine whether it is relevant, irrelevant, or circumstantial. Their findings will be recorded on the sheets provided, requiring them to carefully classify the evidence based on its significance to the case.

ROUND 2: CSI SHOWDOWN

ROUND DURATION: 2 hrs

DELEGATE CAP: 2-4

ELIMINATION: Active

Delegates will need to dive into the forensic world, wielding their knowledge of forensic analysis, case studies, and crime solving as weapons. Those with the sharpest analytical minds shall tower over others, gaining access to delightful assets.

The rapid fire / buzzer battle will entail knowledge regarding the following:

General

- Forensic science
- Chain of custody
- Processing documents
- Evidence collection, reconstruction and contamination
- Physical evidence i.e. firearms, GSR, toolmarks
- Evidence evaluation
- Timelines
- Case analysis
- Chain of Custody

Biology

- Blood components
- ABO & Rh blood groups
- Passive, transfer & projected stains
- Basic bloodstain patterns
- DNA
- Hair

Trace evidence

- Toxicology
- Drugs
- Paint
- Fingerprints

Digital Forensics

- Digital evidence
- Timestamps
- Evidence preservation

Pathology

- Autopsy
- Cause, mechanism & manner of death
- Natural, accident, suicide, homicide, undetermined

ROUND 3: ECHOES OF ENIGMA

ROUND DURATION: 2.5 - 3 hrs

DELEGATE CAP: 2 - 5

ELIMINATION: Active

Get into an adrenaline inducing paper chase – a race between minds to decode ciphers and clues, each leading to the next. Follow the trail, crack the code, and uncover what lies at the heart of the mystery.

The delegates will score points based on the positions they attain when finishing the round.

Prior knowledge of the following ciphers is required:

- Morse Code
- Atbash Cipher
- Symbol Cipher
- Tap Code
- Polybius Cipher
- Caesar Cipher
- Phone Keypad Cipher
- Pigpen Cipher

ROUND 4: THE DETECTIVE'S REBUTTAL

ROUND DURATION: 2.5 - 3 hrs

DELEGATE CAP: 4

Time to walk a mile in a detective's shoes and unleash that detective's instinct! Teams will once again step into the shoes of detectives and take on the challenge of understanding an entire case. They will be provided with a case that has already been "solved", but not correctly. Using the information uncovered, teams must retrace the events of the case, connect the dots, identify the flaws in the existing solution, and determine what they believe actually happened.

But there's more! Alongside working and reworking the case, each team will have to prepare a creative presentation showcasing their reconstruction of the case.

The presentation will be judged based on the following criteria:

- Case understanding and reconstruction
- Crime scene analysis
- Identification of errors and correction
- Alternative solution
- Presentation and communication
- Creativity
- Murder board

Note:

- All presentations must be submitted via email to the category heads by the deadline which will be communicated to the participants. Any team that fails to meet this deadline will forfeit its chance to present during the round. Furthermore, all delegates in a team are allowed to work on the presentation; however maximum of 4 will be permitted on stage to present.

Guidelines:

- The Category Heads reserve the right to make any necessary amendments to the round structure, rules, or procedures on the day of the event, at their sole discretion.
- **The** delegates will need to learn the mentioned cipher languages. A basic understanding and ability to apply them will be sufficient for Round 3.
- Delegates will have to bring laptops to draft their verdict papers and prepare a presentation, which they will showcase to the category heads on Day 4.
- All Delegates must submit their electronic gadgets to the category heads before each round begins - to ensure no artificial intelligence is used to decode/decipher or resolve the mystery and its attached aspects.
- All delegates will bring their own stationery.
- A strict guideline concerns the use of ChatGPT and other AI programmes. Each verdict paper will be run through multiple verification tools, and any team found to be using AI will be immediately disqualified from the category.